



Blended learning is essential to meet India's scale and leadership needs.

Q: Who is an ideal student for IIM Ahmedabad? What profile, background, skills, and work experience matter most?

A: Ideal work experience is easier to define: a couple of years in industry, so students understand organisational dynamics. Fresh graduates often struggle with this.

Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) graduates are welcome; they have proven ability, but the ideal student is not limited to IIT. Today, you don't need to go into the depths of a technological development. Technology is accessible today; what matters is one's ability to apply it.

Our motto *Vidya Viniyoga Vikasa* means development through the application of knowledge. The ideal student has an open mindset, willing to engage with technology and apply knowledge for development, regardless of whether they come from commerce, science or an arts background.

Q: Does the Common Admission Test (CAT) exam help you select such students?

A: Only to an extent. The exam acts as a filter. After shortlisting, we assess the mindset through interviews, group discussions and case study writing. CAT tests analytical and verbal abilities, as the key requirement is an analytical mindset for solving business problems.

Q: How do you view the multiple-campus model now that IIMA has a Dubai campus?

A: India must show its capabilities and lead the Global South. Our philosophy emphasises collective development.

When the Global South grows, India grows. Dubai fits into a deliberate strategy: enabling the Global South to benefit from our capabilities while strengthening India through shared education and future trade. Multi-country campuses allow us to understand regional business contexts, write case studies from

those markets and bring that learning back to India. We aim to prepare leaders for global business, not only in India.

Q: How do you view the entry of foreign universities in India under the new education policy?

A: I welcome them. India's educational capacity cannot meet the scale of growth we foresee. We need far more engineering and management graduates than Indian institutions alone can produce. Foreign universities expand the pool and help prepare talent for the emerging economy.

Given the limited quality seats, many students go abroad. If foreign universities operate here, students receive comparable education at a lower cost, the currency stays in India, and parents benefit.

But quality must match that of the parent campus. Regulators must ensure only strong institutions and faculty enter. If quality is maintained, foreign universities are a win-win. **BT**

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